

# US Patent & Trademark Office

## Patent Public Search | Text View

---

United States Patent Application Publication

20250275642

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

CHAN; Wing Po et al.

---

### REUSABLE COFFEE AND BEVERAGE POD

---

#### Abstract

A coffee and beverage pod includes a body having an interior volume for receiving a beverage ingredient. The coffee and beverage pod is selectively configurable in a low-pressure brewing mode and a high-pressure brewing mode. In the low-pressure brewing mode, a first pressure is necessary to allow for the flow of liquid from the interior volume out of an outlet in the body, and in the high-pressure brewing mode, a second pressure within the interior volume is necessary to allow for the flow of liquid from the interior volume out of the outlet, the second pressure being greater than the first pressure.

---

**Inventors:** CHAN; Wing Po (Hong Kong, CN), YIU; Yik On (Hong Kong, CN)

**Applicant:** Conair LLC (Stamford, CT)

**Family ID:** 96881346

**Assignee:** Conair LLC (Stamford, CT)

**Appl. No.:** 18/591085

**Filed:** February 29, 2024

---

#### Publication Classification

**Int. Cl.:** A47J31/06 (20060101)

**U.S. Cl.:**

**CPC** A47J31/0689 (20130101); A47J31/0605 (20130101);

---

#### Background/Summary

## FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The present invention relates generally to accessories for beverage making devices and, more particularly, to a reusable coffee and beverage pod for a beverage making machine.

## BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0002] Various types of beverage brewers, such as single-serve beverage brewers, have been developed and are popular for home brewing of coffee and other beverages. In a typical single-serve beverage brewer, a disposable beverage filter cartridge containing a dry beverage medium (such as tea or coffee) is disposed within a filter cartridge holder or brewing holster of a beverage or coffee machine. To brew the beverage, the filter cartridge is pierced by inlet and outlet probes to accommodate a through-flow of metered hot water. The hot water infuses the dry beverage medium contained in the cartridge to thereby produce a single serving of the beverage. After the beverage is brewed, the cartridge is removed from the cartridge holder and it is discarded.

[0003] By requiring the use of the disposable cartridges, consumers are limited to the beverage selection of the cartridges on hand. Moreover, with each cartridge being disposed of after use, there is much needless waste. In addition, existing coffee machines and single-serve cartridges, including those of the reusable variety, are only capable of brewing a single type of coffee such as, for example, espresso or drip coffee, but not both.

[0004] In view of the above, there is a need for a reusable coffee and beverage pod suitable for use with a beverage brewer that can be used with any desired dry beverage medium (coffee, tea, etc.) and which can be used to brew a variety of different types of coffee at different pressures.

## SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] It is an object of the present invention to provide a reusable coffee and beverage pod.

[0006] It is another object of the present invention to provide a reusable coffee and beverage pod configured for use in brewing various types of coffee such as espresso and drip coffee.

[0007] It is another object of the present invention to provide a reusable coffee and beverage pod configured for use in brewing coffee and other beverages at different pressures.

[0008] It is another object of the present invention to provide a reusable coffee and beverage pod that prevents over-pressure conditions.

[0009] These and other objects are achieved by the present invention.

[0010] According to an embodiment of the present invention, a coffee and beverage pod includes a body having an interior volume for receiving a beverage ingredient. The coffee and beverage pod is selectively configurable in a low-pressure brewing mode and a high-pressure brewing mode. In the low-pressure brewing mode, a first pressure is necessary to allow for the flow of liquid from the interior volume out of an outlet in the body, and in the high-pressure brewing mode, a second pressure within the interior volume is necessary to allow for the flow of liquid from the interior volume out of the outlet, the second pressure being greater than the first pressure.

[0011] According to yet another embodiment of the present invention, a coffee and beverage pod includes an upper chamber configured to receive a beverage ingredient, and having an outlet, a lower chamber having an outlet, and an adjustable pressure valve having a sealing element. The adjustable pressure valve is moveable between a first position where the sealing element is spaced from the outlet of the upper chamber to provide fluid communication between the upper chamber and the lower chamber, and a second position where the sealing element engages the outlet of the upper chamber to fluidly isolate the upper chamber from the lower chamber.

[0012] According to yet another embodiment of the present invention, a method for brewing a beverage includes the steps of placing a beverage ingredient inside an upper chamber of a beverage pod, the upper chamber having an outlet, and configuring the beverage pod for one of a high-pressure brewing mode or a low-pressure brewing mode. Configuring the beverage pod for the high-pressure brewing mode includes moving an adjustable pressure valve to be in contact with the outlet to inhibit fluid from exiting the upper chamber through the outlet, and configuring the

beverage pod for the low-pressure brewing mode includes moving the adjustable pressure valve to a position where it is spaced from the outlet to allow fluid to exit the upper chamber through the outlet.

---

## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0013] The present invention will be better understood from reading the following description of non-limiting embodiments, with reference to the attached drawings, wherein below:

[0014] FIG. 1 is a perspective, top view of a reusable coffee and beverage pod according to an embodiment of the invention.

[0015] FIG. 2 is a perspective, bottom view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0016] FIG. 3 is a top plan view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0017] FIG. 4 is a bottom plan view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0018] FIG. 5 is a right side elevational view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0019] FIG. 6 is a side, cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0020] FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional, perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0021] FIG. 8 is an exploded, perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0022] FIG. 9 is an enlarged, perspective view of an adjustable pressure valve of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1.

[0023] FIG. 10 is a perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating movement of the adjustable pressure valve to a closed position.

[0024] FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, showing the adjustable pressure valve in the closed position.

[0025] FIG. 12 is a cross-sectional, perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod taken along line A-A of FIG. 3, showing the adjustable pressure valve in the closed position.

[0026] FIG. 13 is a perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating movement of the adjustable pressure valve to an open position.

[0027] FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, showing the adjustable pressure valve in the open position.

[0028] FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional, perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod taken along line A-A of FIG. 3, showing the adjustable pressure valve in the open position.

[0029] FIG. 16 is a cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating operation thereof.

[0030] FIG. 17 is an enlarged, cross-sectional view of a portion of the reusable coffee and beverage pod, showing the flow of water therethrough.

[0031] FIG. 18 is a cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating a high-pressure brewing operation.

[0032] FIG. 19 is a cross-sectional, perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating a high-pressure brewing operation.

[0033] FIG. 20 is a cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating a low-pressure brewing operation.

[0034] FIG. 21 is a cross-sectional, perspective view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 1, illustrating a low-pressure brewing operation.

[0035] FIG. 22 is a cross-sectional view of a reusable coffee and beverage pod according to another embodiment of the present invention, illustrating a high-pressure mode of operation.

[0036] FIG. 23 is a cross-sectional view of the reusable coffee and beverage pod of FIG. 22, illustrating an over pressure condition.

## DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

[0037] With reference to FIGS. **1-8**, a reusable coffee and beverage pod **10** according to an embodiment of the present invention is shown. The coffee and beverage pod **10** includes a generally cup shaped body **12** sized and configured to be received in a filter cartridge holder of a beverage or coffee machine (not shown) in a manner generally known in the art. The body **12** includes a generally cylindrical upper chamber **14**, a generally conical lower chamber **16**, and an actuator in the form of a rotatable control ring **20** intermediate, and interconnecting, the upper chamber **14** and the lower chamber **16**. As best shown in FIGS. **1** and **3**, the reusable coffee and beverage pod **10** includes a lid **18** pivotally connected to the upper chamber **14** about hinge **26**. The lid **18** encloses the open end of the upper chamber **14** and includes an inlet opening or aperture **22** coaxial with the upper and lower chambers **14**, **16** for the ingress of heated water. As best shown in FIGS. **2** and **4**, the lower chamber **16** includes an outlet opening or aperture **24** at the lower end thereof and coaxial with the upper and lower chambers **14**, **16**. As further shown in FIGS. **1-8**, a tab **28** extends from one side of the body **12** adjacent to the hinge **26** and is graspable by a user to manipulate the pod **10**, such during removal and insertion of the pod **10** with respect to the beverage or coffee machine. As best shown in FIG. **4**, an underside of the tab **28** may include an identifying or detection feature or element **30** that enables the beverage or coffee machine to detect when the pod **10** is inserted within the filter cartridge holder. In an embodiment, the identifying feature may be a magnetic strip, a strip of metal, or the like.

[0038] As illustrated in FIGS. **6** and **7**, the internal configuration of the coffee and beverage pod **10** is shown. In an embodiment, the coffee and beverage pod **10** includes a sealing element **32** such as an O-ring or the like that forms a substantially water-tight seal between the lid **18** and the upper rim of the upper chamber **14** of the body **12** when the lid **18** is in the closed position. The coffee and beverage pod **10** also includes a shower head **34** that is configured distribute water evenly, via an array of outlets, through coffee grounds or other beverage ingredient placed within the upper chamber **14**, as disclosed below. In an embodiment, the sealing element **32** and shower head **34** are integrated with the lid **18**. As also shown therein, the upper chamber **14** includes a generally conical bottom having an outlet **36** in fluid communication with the lower chamber **16**, which similarly has a generally conical bottom having outlet **24**. In an embodiment, a lower portion of the outlet **36** has the shape of an inverted cone (having a diameter at a lower end that is greater than a diameter at a location above the lower end). A generally cylindrical filter element **38** is located within the upper chamber **14** and is configured to retain a beverage ingredient such as coffee grounds, tea leaves or the like, but allows for the passage of liquid therethrough. In an embodiment, the filter element **38** may take a variety of forms such as, for example, a fine mesh screen, a porous fabric, or the like.

[0039] FIG. **8** best illustrates the configuration of the control ring **20**. As shown therein, the control ring **20** is annular in shape and includes a plurality of ridges **40** on the exterior surface thereof, which function as gripping elements enabling a user to grasp and rotate the control ring **20** relative to the upper and lower chambers **14**, **16** as described in detail below. An inner periphery of the control ring **20** includes a cam structure **41** which includes a first land **42**, adjacent to an upper end of the control ring **20**, an angled or inclined surface **44**, a second land **46** adjacent to the lower end of the control ring **20** (i.e., at a plane lower than the first land **42**), and a position stop **48**. A similar cam structure may be located on an inner peripheral surface of the control ring **20** on an opposite side thereof.

[0040] With reference to FIGS. **8** and **9**, the coffee and beverage pod **10** also includes a pressure valve **50** positioned within the lower chamber **16**. The pressure valve **50** includes a generally cylindrical central body portion **52** having a frusto-conical sealing element **56** dimensioned and shaped so as to be received within the lower portion of outlet **36** of the upper chamber **14**, as discussed in detail below, and a plurality of circumferential walls **54** arranged concentrically with, and spaced from, the sealing element **56**. The pressure valve **50** further includes a pair of opposed arms **58**, **60** extend from opposite sides of the central body portion **52**, and a pair of biasing

elements such as, for example, compression springs **62, 64**, connected to the arms **58, 60** and depending downwardly therefrom. As best shown in FIG. 7, the springs **62, 64** are received on corresponding posts **66, 68** that extend upwardly from the bottom of the lower chamber **16**. As further shown in FIG. 9, the pressure valve **50** further includes a pair of upstanding tabs or followers **66, 68** configured to interface with the cam structure **41** of the control ring **20** in the manner hereinafter described.

[0041] Turning now to FIGS. **10-15**, the pressure valve **50** is selectively adjustable so as to allow for either high pressure brewing or low-pressure brewing, as desired, and in dependence upon the type of beverage to be produced. With reference to FIGS. **10-12**, the pressure valve **50** can be moved to the closed position by rotating the control ring in a counterclockwise direction, as shown by arrow A in FIG. **10**. In this position, the follower **66** of the pressure valve **50** is seated against the first land **42** of the cam structure **41**, and the springs **62, 64** bias the pressure valve **50**, including the central body portion **52**, upwards. In this position, the frusto-conical sealing element **56** of the pressure valve **50** is seated against the inverted cone shaped portion of outlet **36** in the bottom of the upper chamber **14**, as best shown in FIG. **12**. This is the closed position of the pressure valve **50**.

[0042] With reference to FIGS. **13-15**, the pressure valve **50** can be moved to the open position by rotating the control ring **20** in a clockwise direction, as shown by arrow B in FIG. **13**. This clockwise rotation of the control ring **20** causes the cam structure **41** to exert a downwards force on the follower **66** and/or **68** to move the pressure valve **50** downwardly. In particular, in its closed state (of FIGS. **10-12**), the first land **42** of the cam structure **41** is engaged with the follower **66**. Rotating the control ring **20** causes the inclined surface **44** of the cam structure **41** to move into contact with the follower **66** of the pressure valve **50**, which pushes the pressure valve **50** downwardly against the bias of the springs **62, 64** (thus compressing the springs **62, 64**). As the control ring **20** continues to be rotated, the inclined surface **44** continues to push the pressure valve **50** downwardly until the second land **46** is moved into contact with the follower **66**, as best shown in FIG. **14**. Position stop **48** prevents over rotation of the control ring **20** (by abutting the side of the follower **66**). As best shown in FIG. **15**, in this open position, the frusto-conical sealing element **56** of the pressure valve **50** is spaced from the inverted cone shaped portion of outlet **36** in the bottom of the upper chamber **14**. This is the open position of the pressure valve **50**.

[0043] As will be appreciated, the brewing of espresso requires using fine coffee grounds for quick extraction. The brewing uses high pressure (typically 5-12 bar) to force the hot water to pass through the grounds, resulting in a high concentration of coffee with crema on top. Drip coffee, on the other hand, requires much lower pressure (typically <2 bar) for brewing. Such coffee uses a medium to coarse grind size for brewing. The brewing process takes a longer time to extract the coffee and the water is dripped by gravity, resulting in a clean cup of coffee with no crema on top.

[0044] Importantly, the reusable coffee and beverage pod **10** can be utilized to produce a beverage using high pressure brewing (for example, to produce an espresso beverage) or low-pressure brewing (for example to produce drip-style coffee). Regardless of the mode of operation, coffee grounds of a desired grind size, or a beverage ingredient, can be placed within the filter basket **38** and the lid **18** can then be closed. The pod **10** is then inserted into a filter cartridge holder of a beverage or coffee machine (not shown) in a manner generally known in the art, and a brewing cycle is initiated (typically by the press of a button). Upon commencement of the brewing cycle, heated water enters the upper chamber **14** through the inlet opening **22** of the lid **18**, and is evenly distributed throughout the coffee grounds within the filter basket **38** via the shower head **34**. The heated water passes through the coffee grounds and then through the filter basket/filter element **38** and out of the outlet **36** of the upper chamber **14**. From there, the water passes past the pressure valve **50** and into the lower chamber **16**. The lower chamber **16** collects the coffee and allows the coffee to flow out of the outlet **24** in the bottom thereof as a stream, where it can be collected in a coffee cup or the like. This water flow pathway is illustrated in FIGS. **16** and **17** and, as stated

above, is the same regardless of the mode selected (i.e., regardless of whether the pressure valve 50 is in the open position or closed position).

[0045] To configure the pod 10 or use in a high-pressure brewing mode of operation, such as the production of espresso, the control ring 20 is rotated to the closed position so that the pressure valve 50 abuts the lower end of the upper chamber 14 and so that sealing element 56 is received in the lower portion of outlet 36, as shown in FIGS. 18 and 19. As heated water is distributed to the coffee grounds in the filter basket 38 of the upper chamber 14 in the manner disclosed above, pressure increases in the upper chamber 14. This pressure increase within the upper chamber 14 forces the water through the coffee grounds and the filter element 38. When the pressure within the upper chamber 14 builds up to an extent that it overcomes the upward biasing force of the springs 62, 64, it forces the pressure valve 50 downward, against the spring bias, creating an annular space between the frusto-conical sealing element 56 of the pressure valve 50 and the bottom of upper chamber 14, through which the coffee infused water can escape and enter the lower chamber 16, and ultimately exit through the outlet 24. In an embodiment, the upward biasing elements 62, 64 may be designed and/or selected so that a pressure of about 5 to about 12 bar in the upper chamber 14 can overcome the spring bias and urge the pressure valve 50 downwardly against such spring bias. As will be appreciated, therefore, the pod 10, when the pressure valve 50 thereof is in the closed position, is particularly suited to brewing espresso as it produces a high concentration of coffee with crema on top.

[0046] Conversely, to configure the pod 10 for use in a low-pressure brewing mode of operation, the control ring 20 is rotated to the open position so that the pressure valve 50 is spaced from the lower end of the upper chamber 14 and so that sealing element 56 is spaced from the lower portion of outlet 36, as shown in FIGS. 20 and 21. As heated water is distributed to the coffee grounds in the filter basket 38 of the upper chamber 14, it is permitted to freely flow under the force of gravity through the coffee grounds. The coffee infused water exits the filter element 38 and the upper chamber 14 through outlet 36, and enters the lower chamber 16 through the open pressure valve 50, where it then collects and ultimately exits through outlet 24. As the pressure valve 50 is never in the closed position, significant pressure cannot build up in the upper chamber 14 (in contrast to the high-pressure brewing method described above). That is, because the pressure valve is in the open position, there is much less restriction on the flow of water from the upper chamber 14 to the lower chamber 16. This brewing process, at low pressures (e.g., under 2 bar), results in coffee extraction without crema, producing a drip-style coffee beverage.

[0047] Regardless of the particular mode the pod 10 is placed in (high pressure or low-pressure brewing), the pod 10 is intended to be reused in subsequent brewing operations. In particular, once a beverage is brewed in the manner described above, a user can dump out the used coffee grounds or beverage ingredients, rinse the upper chamber 14 and filter basket 38, and then refill the pod 10 with whatever beverage ingredients/material is desired for a subsequent single serve beverage.

[0048] As disclosed above, importantly, the reusable coffee and beverage pod 10, by being selectively configurable in either high pressure or low-pressure modes of operation, is thus capable of producing a variety of different beverages (e.g., espresso and drip style coffee). This level of functionality has heretofore not been seen in the art and, particularly in the single-serve coffee maker art. Moreover, traditional espresso brewing requires a skilled user, as slight variations in the evenness of the coffee bed and tamping force can greatly affect the brewing pressure. The pod 10 of the present invention, however, removes these variables, and the pressure valve 50 ensures proper pressurization within the brewing chamber which reduces misuses and produces consistent coffee product. While the present invention has been disclosed above as being suitable for single-serve brewing, it is not intended that the present invention be so limited in this regard. In particular, it is contemplated that the pod 10 can be scaled up in volume so as to produce a greater volume of a beverage using either high-or low-pressure brewing.

[0049] Turning now to FIGS. 22 and 23, a reusable coffee and beverage pod 100 according to an

embodiment of the present invention is shown. The beverage pod **100** is generally identical to the beverage pod **10** disclosed above, where like reference numerals designate like parts. As illustrated therein, however, the central body **52** of the adjustable pressure valve **50** includes a small diameter throughbore **102** located concentrically with the central body **52**, upper chamber **14** and lower chamber **16**. In an embodiment, the throughbore **102** is a pinhole. During high pressure brewing, the pressure valve **50** is closed (as disclosed above in connection with pod **10**), leaving the throughbore **102** as the only fluid pathway between the upper chamber **14** and the lower chamber. When the pressure within the upper chamber **14** builds up to a desired brewing pressure, such pressure forces the liquid to pass through the throughbore **102** into the lower chamber **16**, and ultimately out of outlet **24** to produce a beverage such as espresso, as shown in FIG. **22**. In an embodiment, diameter of the throughbore **102** is selected to limit the liquid flow and control the brewing pressure within the upper chamber **14**. For example, in an embodiment, the diameter of the throughbore **102** is chosen so that a pressure in excess of about 5 bar in the upper chamber **14** is necessary to push the liquid through the throughbore **102** and into the lower chamber **16**. Low pressure brewing can be carried out in the manner disclosed above in connection with pod **10**, where control ring **20** is rotated to open the pressure valve **50**.

[0050] With specific reference to FIG. **23**, the reusable coffee and beverage pod **100** is configured to prevent an over pressure condition within the pod **100**. In particular, in the case where excess pressure builds up within the upper chamber **14**, the pressure valve **50** is pushed downwardly by such pressure, causing liquid to flow along the opening between the central body **52** and the lower end of the upper chamber **14** to release the excess pressure, as shown in FIG. **23**. In an embodiment, the biasing force of the springs **62**, **64** is carefully selected to control the pressure valve opening pressure. In various embodiment, the spring elements **62**, **64** are selected so that a pressure in excess of about 20 bar, about 15 bar or about 12 bar in the upper chamber **14** is necessary to urge the valve downwardly to allow flow past the valve **50**, as shown in FIG. **23**.

[0051] In an embodiment, reusable coffee and beverage pods **10**, **100** are configured for use with a variety of existing coffee or beverage making appliances and may include a lid design that avoids collision with a piercing blade on both the top and bottom. In an embodiment, the pods **10**, **100** can be utilized with grind-and-brew style coffee machines, and can receive ground coffee directly from the grinder of such machines. In other embodiments, a specialized grind and brew style machine, or single-serve beverage appliance may be provided to receive the beverage pods **10**, **100**.

[0052] Although this invention has been shown and described with respect to the detailed embodiments thereof, it will be understood by those of skill in the art that various changes may be made and equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the scope of the invention. In addition, modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings of the invention without departing from the essential scope thereof. Therefore, it is intended that the invention not be limited to the particular embodiments disclosed in the above detailed description, but that the invention will include all embodiments falling within the scope of this disclosure.

## Claims

1. A coffee and beverage pod, comprising: a body having an interior volume for receiving a beverage ingredient; wherein the coffee and beverage pod is selectively configurable in a low-pressure brewing mode and a high-pressure brewing mode; wherein in the low-pressure brewing mode, a first pressure is necessary to allow for the flow of liquid from the interior volume out of an outlet in the body; and wherein in the high-pressure brewing mode, a second pressure within the interior volume is necessary to allow for the flow of liquid from the interior volume out of the outlet; and wherein the second pressure is greater than the first pressure.
2. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 1, wherein: the body includes an upper chamber having an

outlet, a lower chamber having an outlet, and an adjustable pressure valve intermediate the upper chamber and the lower chamber.

3. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 2, wherein: the adjustable pressure valve includes a sealing element; and wherein the adjustable pressure valve is moveable between a first position where the sealing element is spaced from the outlet of the upper chamber to provide fluid communication between the upper chamber and the lower chamber, and a second position where the sealing element engages the outlet of the upper chamber to fluidly isolate the upper chamber from the lower chamber.
4. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 3, wherein: the adjustable pressure valve includes at least one biasing element configured to bias the pressure valve to the second position.
5. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 4, further comprising: an actuator configured to move the adjustable pressure valve between the first position and the second position; wherein the first position corresponds to the low-pressure brewing mode; and wherein the second position corresponds to the high-pressure brewing mode.
6. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 5, wherein: the actuator is a rotatable ring.
7. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 6, wherein: the rotatable ring includes a cam structure configured to urge the adjustable valve downwardly, against the bias of the at least one biasing element, to the first position upon rotation of the rotatable ring in a first direction.
8. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 7, wherein: the cam structure includes a first land, a second land spaced vertically from the first land, and an angled surface extending between the first land and the second land.
9. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 2, wherein: the upper chamber includes filter element.
10. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 1, wherein: the first pressure is zero pressure or the force of gravity; and the second pressure is greater than about 5 bar.
11. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 2, wherein: the adjustable pressure valve includes a throughbore providing fluid communication between the upper chamber and the lower chamber.
12. A coffee and beverage pod, comprising: an upper chamber configured to receive a beverage ingredient, and having an outlet, a lower chamber having an outlet; and an adjustable pressure valve having a sealing element, the adjustable pressure valve being moveable between a first position where the sealing element is spaced from the outlet of the upper chamber to provide fluid communication between the upper chamber and the lower chamber, and a second position where the sealing element engages the outlet of the upper chamber to fluidly isolate the upper chamber from the lower chamber.
13. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 12, wherein: the adjustable pressure valve includes a biasing element configured to bias the pressure valve to the second position.
14. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 13, further comprising: an actuator configured to move the adjustable pressure valve between the first position and the second position.
15. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 14, wherein: the actuator includes a cam structure configured to urge the adjustable valve downwardly, against the bias of the biasing element, to the first position upon actuation of the actuator.
16. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 15, wherein: the cam structure includes a first land, a second land spaced vertically from the first land, and an angled surface extending between the first land and the second land.
17. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 16, wherein: the actuator is a rotatable ring.
18. The coffee and beverage pod of claim 12, wherein: the upper chamber includes filter element.
19. A method for brewing a beverage, comprising the steps of: placing a beverage ingredient inside an upper chamber of a beverage pod, the upper chamber having an outlet; and configuring the beverage pod for one of a high-pressure brewing mode or a low-pressure brewing mode; wherein configuring the beverage pod for the high-pressure brewing mode includes moving an adjustable pressure valve to be in contact with the outlet to inhibit fluid from exiting the upper chamber



through the outlet; and wherein configuring the beverage pod for the low-pressure brewing mode includes moving the adjustable pressure valve to a position where it is spaced from the outlet to allow fluid to exit the upper chamber through the outlet.

**20.** The method according to claim 19, wherein moving the adjustable pressure valve includes rotating a control ring of the beverage pod.

---